

CALL FOR APPLICATIONS: INNOVATIVE HEALTH BUSINESS IDEAS

The Africa Health Collaborative-Addis Ababa University (AHC-AAU), in partnership with the Mastercard Foundation, is pleased to announce the launch of the Health Business Idea Competition dedicated to Addis Ababa University (AAU) students, including both undergraduate and postgraduate students. This initiative invites students to propose innovative and impactful health-related business ideas that have the potential to contribute to sustainable transformation within Ethiopia's health sector.

Aligned with the core mission of the Africa Health Collaborative-Addis Ababa University to strengthen the primary healthcare workforce, advance health entrepreneurship, and catalyze resilient local health innovation ecosystems, this competition seeks forward-thinking ideas that address pressing health challenges. The initiative aims to stimulate entrepreneurship, innovation, job creation, and evidence-informed policy solutions, while supporting the development of scalable ventures that improve health access, quality, affordability, and equity in Ethiopia.

WHY PARTICIPATE?

- This competition provides a unique opportunity to transform innovative health ideas into viable and impactful ventures. Selected participants will benefit from the following opportunities:
- **Seed Support:** Winning teams will receive a modest seed grant (3,000 USD) to support the initial development of their health venture.
- **Mentorship and Coaching:** Personalized mentoring and coaching from local & international experts at the Health Entrepreneurship Hub, Africa Health Collaborative-Addis Ababa University.
- **Pitching and Networking Opportunities:** Platforms to present your idea, connect with industry experts, investors, and innovation stakeholders.
- **Pre-Incubation Training:** Intensive training designed to strengthen participants' entrepreneurial mindset and practical venture development skills.
- **Incubation Support:** Opportunities for selected ventures to enter the incubation program for further development, validation, and growth.

ELIGIBILITY:

- **Participation Format:** Applications may be submitted by individuals or teams of up to three (3) members.
- **Idea Focus:** Submitted proposals must focus on health-related business ideas that address challenges within the health sector.
- **Innovation Requirement:** Ideas should be original, feasible, scalable, and innovative, addressing unmet needs related to health access, affordability, equity, quality of care, or health technology.
- **Eligibility:** Applicants must be currently enrolled students of Addis Ababa University (AAU), including both undergraduate and postgraduate students.
- **Submission Format:** Use the customized Health Business Plan Template below (adapted for this competition). Submit as a Word document or PDF (max 10 pages, 12pt font, single-spaced). Include visuals, diagrams, or prototypes if relevant.
- **Deadline:** March 29, 2026 (submissions received after this date will not be considered).
- **Selection Process:** Submissions will be assessed according to the following criteria: innovation (30%), market potential (25%), feasibility (20%), potential impact (15%), and quality of presentation (10%). Shortlisted candidates will be invited to participate in an intensive hands-on training at a designated AHC-AAU facility.

SUBMISSION PROCEDURE:

- Applicants are required to submit their completed application as a single PDF file via email to health.startups@aaau.edu.et
- Email Subject Line: Health Business Idea Competition – [Your Idea Title]
- Submission Format: The entire application, including all required documents, must be compiled and submitted as one PDF file.
- Confidentiality: All submitted business ideas and related documents will be treated with strict confidentiality and will be used solely for the purpose of evaluation under the competition.
- Health Business Idea Submission Template

HEALTH BUSINESS IDEA SUBMISSION TEMPLATE

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- Provide a brief overview of your innovative idea. Include key points such as the problem your idea solves, the target market, the business opportunity, and the expected impact.
- Idea Title:
- Problem Statement:
- Proposed Solution:
- Target Market:
- Key Impact/Value Proposition:

2. BUSINESS DESCRIPTION

Explain the business concept in more detail. Cover the following areas:

- Business Idea: Describe your innovative idea, its unique features, and how it works.
- Business Model: Outline how your idea will generate revenue.
- Market Need: Explain the gap or opportunity in the market that your idea addresses.

3. MARKET ANALYSIS

Describe the target audience and market for your idea.

- Target Market: Who are your customers?
- Market Size: Provide information about the market potential (size, growth trends).
- Competitive Landscape: Identify any existing competitors or alternatives in the market.
- Unique Selling Proposition (USP): What makes your idea stand out from competitors?

4. PRODUCT/SERVICE DEVELOPMENT

Detail the key features of your product or service and the development process.

- Product/Service Description: What are the main features and functionalities?
- Innovation: Explain what makes your idea innovative and cutting-edge.
- Development Timeline: Provide a rough timeline for developing your product or service (research, prototyping, testing).

5. MARKETING AND SALES STRATEGY

Outline your strategy for promoting and selling your product or service.

- Marketing Strategy: How will you reach and attract customers? (digital marketing, partnerships)
- Sales Strategy: What is your plan for converting leads into sales?

6. FINANCIAL PLAN

Provide a basic financial outlook for your idea.

- Health Venture Costs: What are the estimated initial costs for launching the idea?
- Revenue Streams: List the expected sources of income.
- Profitability: Provide a rough estimate of your break-even point or profit margin.
- Financial Projection: At least 3-5 years revenue projection.

7. TEAM

Introduce the key people behind the idea.

- Founder(s): Names and brief bios.
- Key Roles: List any other team members or collaborators and their roles.

8. RISKS AND CHALLENGES

Identify the potential risks your business may face and how you plan to mitigate them.

- Main Risks:
- Mitigation Strategies:

9. ASK & CALL TO ACTION

Summarize the potential of your idea and include a call to action (seeking funding, partnerships, or support).